

DDPM Exam 2 — Test-Day Tactics & Pacing

DDPM Exam 2 Test-Day Tactics & Playbook

This playbook establishes the tactical execution protocol for Exam 2 of the Data-Driven Product Management programme.

[!IMPORTANT]

Confirmed Operational Parameters & Scope Rules

- **Confirmed Operational Parameters:** 45 Questions | 60-Minute Duration (3:30 PM–4:30 PM IST, Sun 16 Aug) | **No Negative Marking** (Answer 100% of questions).

1. Confirmed Operating Rules & Schedule

Parameter	Confirmed Rule	Tactical Instruction
Question Count	**45 Questions**	Target pace: ~1.33 minutes (80 seconds) per item.
Exam Duration	**60 Minutes** (3:30 PM – 4:30 PM IST)	Log in by 3:20 PM IST; start promptly at 3:30 PM.
Negative Marking	**No Negative Marking (0 Penalty)**	**Answer 100% of questions.** Never leave any question blank.
Target Score	**≥60% ("Good" Band)**	Aim for ≥27 correct out of 45 items for solid pass; ≥36 for distinction.

2. Three-Pass Execution Strategy (45 Questions in 60 Minutes)

Adopt a disciplined three-pass execution strategy to maximize point capture across all 45 questions:

[Pass 1: Direct Recall & Easy Wins] ---> [Pass 2: Scenario Analysis & Calculations] ---> [Pass 3: Final Review & 100% Completion]

(Minutes 00 - 35 | ~60% Time) (Minutes 35 - 50 | ~25% Time) (Minutes 50 - 58 | ~15% Time)

Pass 1: Direct Recall & Unambiguous Items (Min 00–35)

- **Objective:** Lock in ~25–30 easy, unambiguous points across all modules rapidly.
- **Action:** Answer all clean recall items instantly (e.g., SERVQUAL dimensions, NIST CSF functions, Agile Manifesto values, ISO 25010 9 characteristics).
- **Rule:** If a question involves complex calculations (e.g., break-even volume, CLV, ATAR market share) or dense scenario stems, select your best tentative answer immediately and flag it for Pass 2. Do not spend >80 seconds on any single item in Pass 1.

Pass 2: Scenario Analysis & Numerical Calculations (Min 35–50)

- **Objective:** Execute calculations and analyze remaining ~12–15 complex scenario-based items.
- **Action:** Return to flagged questions. Perform financial calculations (Natureview break-even, Springfield fixed cost coverage, T2B calibrated trial discounting) on scratch paper.

- **Rule:** Apply the **Best-Answer Elimination Method** (Section 3) for dense scenario items with homogeneous distractors.

Pass 3: Final Review & 100% Completion (Min 50–58)

- **Objective:** Ensure 100% submission completeness across all 45 items.
- **Action:** Verify every single question has a selected answer.
- **Rule:** Since negative marking is confirmed at **0 penalty**, never leave any item un-answered. Submit final test by Minute 58.

3. Best-Answer Elimination Method (Exam-1 Post-Mortem Directive)

The Item Design Challenge

The post-mortem of Exam 1 (`docs/exam-1-post-mortem.md`) identified that lost marks were driven by **Best-Answer MCQs with Parallel Homogeneous Distractors**:

- Stems and options use dense, complex academic register.
- Options share parallel grammatical structure, identical length, and belong to the same conceptual family.
- Simple true/false elimination fails because options are not factually false—they differ in **degree of correctness and strategic alignment**.

4-Step Best-Answer Elimination Algorithm

Step 1: Core Goal Extraction ==> Step 2: Scope & Boundary Mapping ==> Step 3: Primary Standard Filter ==> Step 4: Degree-of-Correctness Selection

1. Step 1: Core Goal Extraction

- Strip away academic filler text from the stem. Identify the exact underlying decision metric (e.g., maximizing contribution margin, minimizing channel conflict, selecting proper LOD scope).

2. Step 2: Scope & Boundary Mapping

- Identify unstated assumptions in distractor options. Eliminate options that rely on extreme conditions or unmentioned constraints.

3. Step 3: Primary Standard Filter

- Cross-reference options against primary authorities (e.g., NIST CSF v2.0, Scrum Guide 2020, GA4 Specification, ISO 25010:2023). Eliminate options that contradict primary definitions.

4. Step 4: Degree-of-Correctness Selection

- Evaluate the remaining options. Select the option that provides the most direct, unassailable, and comprehensive resolution to the problem posed in the stem.

4. No-Negative-Marking Strategy (\$EV\$ Mathematics)

With negative marking **confirmed at 0 penalty**, the expected value (\$EV\$) of answering every question—even when uncertain—is strictly positive:

$$\text{\$}\text{\textit{Expected Value}} \text{\$} (EV) = (P_{\text{\textit{correct}}} \times +1.0) - (P_{\text{\textit{incorrect}}} \times 0) = P_{\text{\textit{correct}}} > 0\text{\$}$$

- **Blind Guess (4 choices):** $EV = \frac{1}{4}(+1.0) = +0.25\text{\$}$ points.
- **After 1 Elimination (3 choices):** $EV = \frac{1}{3}(+1.0) = +0.33\text{\$}$ points.
- **After 2 Eliminations (2 choices):** $EV = \frac{1}{2}(+1.0) = +0.50\text{\$}$ points.

Core Mandate: Submit an answer for all 45 questions. Leaving any question blank guarantees 0 points, whereas guessing on an un-eliminated 4-option item adds $\text{\$}+0.25\text{\$}$ expected points to your total score.

5. Technical & Mettl Environment Checklist

1. Browser & Webcam Setup:

- Log in to Mettl by 3:20 PM IST (10 minutes prior to exam start).
- Ensure camera framing shows face clearly; close all non-exam browser tabs, background apps, and notification centers.

2. Proctor Communication:

- If a technical glitch or proctor warning occurs, remain calm. Use the built-in Mettl chat window to communicate immediately with the invigilator.

3. Scratch Paper Hygiene:

- Keep clean paper and pen ready for numerical calculations (Natureview, Springfield, T2B discounting, CLV).
- Show scratch paper to camera if requested by Mettl proctor.